

LIFEWS AgriShine(TM) GrowMeal(TM)

TEACHER TRAINING & CERTIFICATION PROGRAM

Induction | Competency Training | Microteaching | Certification | Train-the-Trainer

Core curriculum	15 modules; recommended guided-learning duration: 57 hours.
Certification principle	Competence must be demonstrated. Attendance alone does not equal certification.
Progression	Trained Teacher -> Certified Teacher -> Lead Teacher -> Certified Trainer.
Safety	Critical safety/safeguarding competence is a certification gate.

15-MODULE TRAINING CURRICULUM

Code	Module	Learning outcome	Hours
M01	GrowMeal Foundations	Understand AgriShine/GrowMeal purpose, learning architecture, level progression and the 12-week cycle.	3
M02	Garden Safety, Safeguarding & Hygiene	Apply site, tool, learner-supervision, food-contact and incident-control standards.	4
M03	Garden Systems & Operations	Operate level-appropriate gardens, water systems, tools, inputs, maintenance and records.	5
M04	Vocabulary, Flashcards & Demonstration	Teach technical language and model practical procedures effectively.	3
M05	Practical Activity Facilitation	Prepare, facilitate, differentiate and assess hands-on GrowMeal practical work.	5
M06	Journals, Observation & Evidence	Develop age-appropriate observation, measurement, recording and evidence quality.	4
M07	Garden Missions & Problem Solving	Facilitate applied challenges without solving them for learners.	3
M08	Ingredient Lab & Farm-to-Food	Teach ingredient investigation, post-harvest thinking, food journeys and food-safety boundaries.	4
M09	Food Smart Challenges	Facilitate evidence-based food, water, waste, storage and resource decisions.	3
M10	Assessment, Rubrics & Moderation	Assess four dimensions, apply 0-3 rubrics, moderate judgments and manage reassessment.	5
M11	Food Smart Passport & Learner Progression	Verify learner achievements and manage level-completion evidence.	2
M12	12-Week Planning & Classroom Integration	Build a coherent weekly sequence using the full GrowMeal resource chain.	4
M13	Inclusion & Differentiation	Adapt access, roles, scaffolding and extension while preserving learning standards.	3
M14	Monitoring, Reporting & School Quality	Use operational records, KPIs, teacher observation and school certification evidence.	3
M15	Microteaching & Practical Competency Assessment	Demonstrate a complete GrowMeal lesson/practical under observation.	6

Total recommended guided-learning time: 57 hours.

1. PROGRAM PURPOSE

Purpose	Prepare teachers and facilitators to deliver GrowMeal safely, consistently and practically, while producing reliable learner evidence.
Audience	Nursery, Primary, JSS and SSS teachers; school GrowMeal coordinators; approved facilitators; future trainers.
Training model	Knowledge instruction + guided practice + garden practicals + assessment + microteaching + supervised implementation.
Minimum principle	Course attendance alone does not establish teaching competence. Certification requires demonstrated performance.

2. TRAINING PATHWAY

Stage 1 - Induction	Orientation to GrowMeal, resources, safety, gardens and the 12-week system.
Stage 2 - Core training	Complete M01-M14 with practical exercises and knowledge checks.
Stage 3 - Competency assessment	Complete M15 microteaching/practical assessment and submit required evidence.
Stage 4 - Supervised implementation	Deliver GrowMeal in a school setting and receive observation/feedback where required.
Stage 5 - Certification	Certification decision based on required scores, safety competence and evidence.
Stage 6 - Renewal	Participate in refresher learning and maintain evidence of active implementation.

3. COMPETENCY DOMAINS

Pedagogy	Objectives, questioning, demonstrations, practical learning, differentiation and feedback.
Garden practice	Safe tool use, water, maintenance, garden systems and operational judgment.
Evidence/data	Observation, measurement, recording, investigation quality and interpretation.
Food literacy	Ingredient Lab, Farm-to-Food, Food Smart Challenges and appropriate food-safety boundaries.
Assessment	Four-dimensional assessment, rubric application, moderation, remediation and passport verification.
Professional practice	Planning, safeguarding, records, collaboration, reflection and continuous improvement.

4. TRAINING DELIVERY STANDARD

Facilitator preparation	Use the current GrowMeal manuals/resources, inspect training gardens, prepare materials and verify safety before participants arrive.
Practice ratio	Training should include substantial participant practice. Demonstration-only workshops are insufficient.
Context	Use the same low-cost/DIY options teachers may need in schools, while explaining where substitutions are not acceptable.
Evidence	Participants keep a training record containing tasks, reflections, assessment results and facilitator verification.
Feedback	Provide specific feedback linked to observable teaching/practical criteria.

5. CERTIFICATION ASSESSMENT

Knowledge check	Assess GrowMeal architecture, safety, pedagogy, resource use, assessment and operations.
Practical competency	Observe garden/tool/material handling, measurement, setup, cleanup and troubleshooting.
Microteaching	Participant teaches a short GrowMeal lesson including objective, demonstration, learner task, questioning, evidence check and closure.
Planning task	Participant prepares a 12-week or selected-week plan using correct GrowMeal resource links.
Assessment task	Participant scores sample learner evidence using the GrowMeal rubric and explains the decision.
Safety gate	A participant who demonstrates unsafe practice in a critical safeguarding, tool, hygiene or site-control area cannot be certified until reassessed.

6. CERTIFICATION LEVELS

GrowMeal Trained Teacher	Completed core training and passed knowledge/practical requirements; ready for supported implementation.
GrowMeal Certified Teacher	Demonstrated secure teaching competence through microteaching and implementation evidence.
GrowMeal Lead Teacher	Certified Teacher with strong implementation evidence who can mentor colleagues and support school quality processes.
GrowMeal Certified Trainer	Lead-level practitioner who has completed Train-the-Trainer requirements and is authorized under LIFEWS procedures to train/assess others.
Status integrity	Titles should only be issued when the required evidence is verified; participation certificates should be clearly distinguished from competency certification.

7. PASS STANDARD

Knowledge	Recommended minimum 70% on the core knowledge assessment.
Practical	Average at least 3 on the 0-4 practical rubric, with no critical safety criterion below 3.
Microteaching	Average at least 3 on the 0-4 teaching rubric.
Assessment literacy	Demonstrate acceptable scoring consistency on moderation exercises.
Implementation	For Certified/Lead status, provide verified school implementation evidence as specified by the program.
Reassessment	Participants below standard receive targeted feedback and repeat only the unmet competency components where appropriate.

8. 0-4 TRAINER RUBRIC

4 - Exemplary	Accurate, safe, independent and adaptive performance; explains reasoning and can support others.
3 - Secure	Accurate and safe performance at the expected standard with appropriate independence.
2 - Developing	Core competence is visible but consistency, accuracy, independence or judgment needs improvement.
1 - Beginning	Limited competence; substantial prompting/correction required.
0 - Not demonstrated	No usable evidence, or performance is fundamentally incorrect/unsafe.

9. MICROTEACHING OBSERVATION

Opening	States an age-appropriate objective and activates relevant vocabulary/prior knowledge.
Demonstration	Models the critical process and safety points clearly.
Learner activity	Creates meaningful learner participation rather than passive observation.
Questioning	Uses questions that reveal understanding and move toward evidence/reasoning.
Evidence	Checks the intended learner output or competence.
Differentiation	Responds to access/support/extension needs.
Management	Uses time, groups, materials and cleanup effectively.
Closure	Consolidates the learning and links to journal, mission, assessment or next action.

10. TRAIN-THE-TRAINER PATHWAY

Eligibility	Normally requires GrowMeal Certified/Lead Teacher status plus strong implementation evidence.
Trainer learning	Adult facilitation, demonstration coaching, observation, feedback, moderation, training logistics, safeguarding and certification integrity.
Co-facilitation	Candidate co-delivers training with an authorized trainer and receives documented feedback.
Assessment	Candidate plans and delivers a training segment, assesses participant practical/microteaching evidence and demonstrates scoring consistency.
Authorization	Trainer status is granted under LIFEWS procedures and may be limited, renewed or suspended based on quality evidence.
Quality control	Trainers must use current program materials and must not lower certification standards to increase pass rates.

11. REFRESHER & RENEWAL

Refresher triggers	Major resource revisions, prolonged inactivity, repeated quality concerns, new garden systems or scheduled renewal.
Evidence	Use recent teaching observation, professional learning, assessment moderation and implementation records.
Targeted refreshers	Focus on the actual gap - for example safety, data quality, practical facilitation, assessment or food-safety procedures.
Renewal decision	Renewal should confirm continued competence rather than merely elapsed time.

12. TRAINING RECORDS & QUALITY ASSURANCE

Records	Participant identity, modules completed, attendance, assessment scores, practical observations, microteaching, reassessment and certification decision.
Assessor	Record the trainer/assessor responsible for each competency judgment.
Moderation	Periodically compare trainer scoring across cohorts to protect consistent standards.
Version control	Record the edition/version of major GrowMeal materials used during training.
Confidentiality	Handle participant and school records according to applicable LIFEWS and school data/privacy procedures.

APPENDIX A - PARTICIPANT TRAINING RECORD

Module	Completed	Score / Evidence	Trainer initials
M01 - GrowMeal Foundations			
M02 - Garden Safety, Safeguarding & Hygiene			
M03 - Garden Systems & Operations			
M04 - Vocabulary, Flashcards & Demonstration			
M05 - Practical Activity Facilitation			
M06 - Journals, Observation & Evidence			
M07 - Garden Missions & Problem Solving			
M08 - Ingredient Lab & Farm-to-Food			
M09 - Food Smart Challenges			
M10 - Assessment, Rubrics & Moderation			
M11 - Food Smart Passport & Learner Progression			
M12 - 12-Week Planning & Classroom Integration			
M13 - Inclusion & Differentiation			
M14 - Monitoring, Reporting & School Quality			
M15 - Microteaching & Practical Competency Assessment			

APPENDIX B - MICROTEACHING SCORECARD

Criterion	0-4	Evidence / Feedback
Objective/vocabulary		
Demonstration		
Safety/safeguarding		
Learner participation		
Questioning		
Evidence/assessment		
Differentiation		
Materials/group management		
Cleanup		
Closure/reflection		

APPENDIX C - CERTIFICATION DECISION RECORD

Participant	_____
School / organization	_____
Knowledge score	_____ %
Practical score	_____ / 4
Microteaching score	_____ / 4
Safety gate	Clear / Not clear
Implementation evidence	Verified / Pending / Not required
Decision	Trained / Certified / Lead / Trainer / Reassessment required
Assessor	_____
Decision date	_____
Renewal/review date	_____